

Interim Assessment Tool Selection Update

Background and Policy Context

In 2025 Oregon lawmakers passed Senate Bill 141 (2025), also known as the 2025 Education Accountability Act. This bill includes the requirement that all Oregon school districts implement interim assessments in reading and mathematics for students in grades K-8 beginning the fall of 2026. The State Board of Education approved four assessments that districts can choose from: i-Ready Inform (also known as i-Ready Diagnostic), NWEA MAP Growth, Renaissance Star, and Cambium Smarter Balanced Interim Assessments. The bill requires districts to select one or more assessments from this list to meet the requirement (districts can choose a single assessment or multiple assessments as long as all students K-8 are provided interim assessments three times each year for reading and mathematics). Districts must report assessment results to their school boards after each window as well as reporting to the Oregon Department of Education (ODE).

Community Engagement Process and Outcomes

The PPS Research, Assessment, and Accountability department collected feedback from teachers, school administrators and families to help determine what interim assessment PPS will use beginning in the 2026-2027 school year. Highlights from feedback comments included recommendations to:

- have the same assessment in all grades (K-8) and across both subjects, reading and mathematics;
- retain i-Ready, as the reporting is robust and includes both achievement scores and growth scores;
- keep the primary focus on usefulness of results to inform classroom instruction and individual student learning.

To read more about feedback received, you can view the full community engagement report here.

Interim Assessment Selection

Based on community input and district expertise, PPS is planning to use the Curriculum Associates i-Ready Inform as our K-8 interim assessment tool for both mathematics and reading starting in the 2026-2027 school year. i-Ready was selected because it can be used in all grades K-8, is computer adaptive, provides growth and achievement scores, provides a dyslexia screener, and does not increase teacher workload. Additionally, it is in alignment with the currently adopted K-5 math curriculum and its continued use will ensure continuity of the assessment results. Finally, the selection of i-Ready honors

the majority of the feedback received and will provide assessment and platform continuity for all students in grades K-8. The selection of i-Ready will keep the primary focus of interim assessments on the usefulness of the assessment results to inform instruction and individual student learning.

In addition, the i-Ready Inform assessment suite offers teacher-administered 1:1 literacy tasks for our youngest learners to provide valuable insights directly to educators on early literacy development and dyslexia risk. These are short 1 minute probes and can also serve as progress monitoring tools across the K-6 spectrum when a student is in need of intensive intervention. This tool will replace our current MAP Fluency screener at no additional cost.

It is worth noting that these interim assessments are part of our broader assessment system, and will not replace curriculum embedded assessments. A full assessment calendar with training and support will be made available before the start of the 2026-2027 School year.

Next Steps and Implications for Our Work

We will be working with Curriculum Associates on preparing a contract that will go before the PPS Board of Education for approval. Because of our current math adoption, many PPS educators are already familiar with the assessment, but educators not yet familiar with i-Ready will receive professional development on how to use the assessment and results. Schools will begin using i-Ready in grades K-8 three times a year (fall, winter and spring) at the start of the 2026-2027 school year.

While details about reporting are still being worked out, results will be available to parents, teachers, school administrators, and the Board of Education. Results will be formally reported three times a year after each testing window, and, more importantly, available for classroom use on an ongoing basis.

Why not the Cambium Smarter Balanced Interim Assessments?

After a thorough evaluation of Cambium Smarter Balanced Interim Assessments and a review of educator feedback, it became evident that the platform’s requirement for some manual scoring would place an undue administrative burden on our staff. Furthermore, Cambium only addresses requirements for grades 3–8, necessitating a separate, disjointed solution for K–2. Consequently, the district has selected i-Ready. This transition offers the most cost-neutral path forward while ensuring a cohesive K–8 experience that aligns with our current curriculum and leverages our educators' existing expertise.



Chart with Comparisons

Category	MAP Growth	i-Ready	Cambium Assessments	Renaissance Star
Grades K-8	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
In Use in PPS	Yes	Yes	No	No
Computer Adaptive	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Growth Scores	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Achievement Scores	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Teacher Workload	Remains the same	Remains the same	Increases	Remains the same
Dyslexia Screener	Not Included	Included	Not Included	Not Included
Cost as related to current contracts	Increased	Decreased	Decreased*	Decreased

*Note: While the Cambium assessments are free to Oregon, they do not cover grades K-2 and, therefore, require a financial investment in an additional assessment in order to meet the ODE requirement.